

Data card setup

1. If your data card came with an installation CD, insert it into the CD drive of your computer.
2. If your data card didn't come with an installation CD, insert the data card into a compatible PCMCIA port on your laptop.
3. Your CD or data card will then install the Connection software onto your computer. When instructed, follow the onscreen instructions to install the connection software and complete the software installation.
4. Once the software has been installed, double-click on the Service Provider's Wireless Broadband Icon.
5. The Wireless software will locate the Service Provider's network and display the available network in the bottom left-hand corner.
6. Once the modem has located the network, click on the Connect button.
7. Now, open your browser and start surfing the internet!

Other uses

More advanced users can make use of wireless data cards along with a special router, to create their very own DSL-type connection — the data card becomes their ISP. Plug as many as five cards into an 802.11b/g/n router to do this. For example, if you've a temporary research site, and you need to connect multiple computers to the internet; you can use the data card's internet connection and the router to set up the link.

Tethering

We've made passing references to tethering before in this book. Let's take a closer look at what tethering is all about – iPhone tethering as well as Android tethering.

Tethering is a general technique available on many cell phones and smartphones to access the internet. With the right software and data plan from a cellphone carrier, it allows users to connect their smartphone to a computer and use the phone's 3G internet connection to provide wireless, always-on connectivity to the computer.

iPhone tethering

When you use an iPhone as a wireless modem to provide internet access to a computer or other Wi-Fi-enabled device, like an iPad or iPod Touch, it's called iPhone Tethering.